

005 Build a den

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Set up a den near a tree in the backyard and you'll have a private hideout—a place to hang out with your friends. Make it waterproof, and you can have sleepovers there when the weather is good.

What you need

- Stakes or poles
- Material: tarpaulins, sacking, and old bedding
- Twine or rope
- Large tree

1 First, decide where you want your den to be. Building it next to a large tree not only gives you an instant “back wall,” but it also provides cover, shade, and stability if the den leans against it or is tied to its trunk or branches.

2 For a simple framework, arrange the stakes in a teepee. Push the bottom ends into the ground, then tie them together at the top with twine.

3 Drape and tie your fabric pieces onto the stakes. You might use all non-waterproof material first, then cover them with a tarpaulin if you want to use the den in wet weather.



Waterproof groundsheet

4 If the ground is damp, lay a waterproof groundsheet or tarp down as a floor. Remember to leave an opening for a doorway!

006 Make a slingshot catapult

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Stretch a thick rubber band across a strong, forked stick. Insert a paper ball or dried pea between your thumb and finger and pull back the rubber band. Aim at a can or rock (never at animals or people), and let fly.